

Medicare, Medicaid, or both?

They are different programs with different rules — and having both is common.

MEDICARE

Based on age or disability

You are 65 or older, or you have had disability benefits for 24 months, or you have ESRD or ALS. Your income does not matter.

MEDICAID

Based on income

Your income and assets are under your state's limits. Rules and names differ by state. Any age.

BOTH — DUAL ELIGIBLE

You qualify for each

Medicare pays first, Medicaid fills gaps. Premiums, copays and long-term care may be covered. Most help available.

If you have Medicare and a low income, check Medicaid and the Medicare Savings Programs. Many people who qualify never apply.

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